Passing OSCP exam… or not?

Yet another review on OSCP
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Cert, cert, certs…

>_ whoami

- Work as a penetration tester
- 0 certs prior to this
- *Somewhat experienced*

What is OSCP?

The **OSCP** is widely regarded as the gold standard for hands-on penetration testing. It teaches you how to identify, exploit, and escalate privileges across a range of operating systems and network environments through rigorous, self-driven learning and a challenging 24-hour exam.

Key focus areas:

- Network and system exploitation
- Privilege escalation (Windows and Linux)
- Active Directory attacks
- Real-world offensive operations

Ideal for:
Security professionals who want to establish themselves as penetration testers, red teamers, or vulnerability assessors. It’s the best entry point into offensive security if you want to prove your ability to think creatively under pressure and apply methodology to unpredictable environments.

The syllabus

- A little bit of everything from some pentesting stuff
- No prerequisites
- https://www.offsec.com/courses/pen-200/

Exam Structure

- 24 hours, just like your CTFs~ 🤪
- AD set + 3 standalones
- Min. 70 points to pass
- Requires submitting a “professional” penetration test report

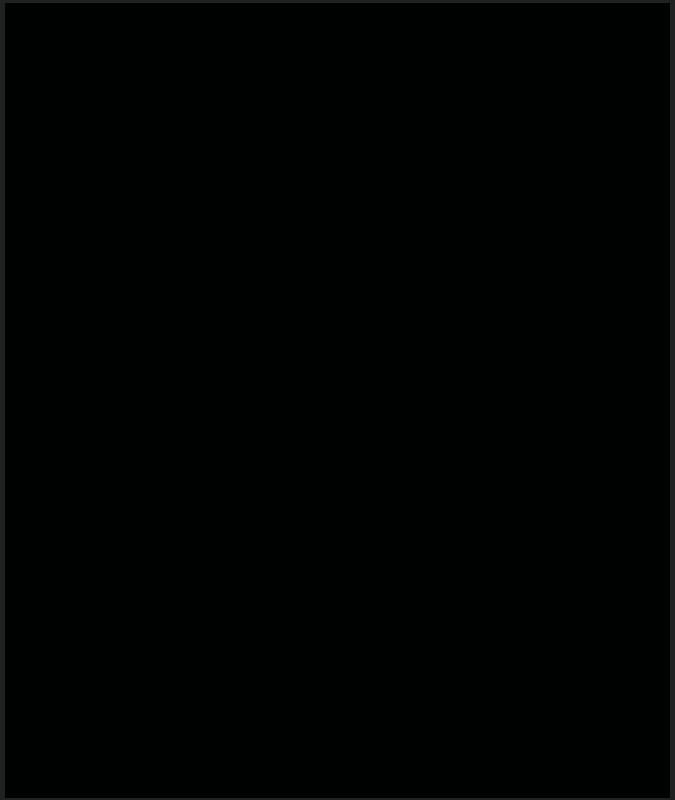
Training arc

- Try to complete the course
- TJ Null’s list
- Lainkusanagi list
- Offsec’s Challenge labs

Exam day

- Scheduled in a month
- Making progress fast
- ts in the bag, ezpz 😏

I failed



H/T ESPN'S *THE JUMP*

“

I GOT ONE MORE IN ME.

VINCE CARTER ON RETURNING FOR HIS 22ND SEASON

back for round two

- Scheduled right after the cooldown period
- More preparation
- Lessons learned from first attempt
- 2nd time the charm

tips

- Skip the course
- Be gentle with the exam machines
- Reset if something is sus
- Keep it simple
- Mental game more important than technical

The Bad

- 1749 USD ~ 7k during my time, now it’s about 6.8k
- Course content not that good
- Exam is very rushed
- Exam environment was slow

The Good

- Well recognised cert, may help you in finding jobs
- Offsec challenge labs and PG Practice were fun